

Copilot Cowork FAQ for Partners

About this document: This FAQ document provides information about Copilot Cowork, including its positioning, capabilities, availability, and scenarios.

Last updated: May 4, 2026. Please make sure to review assets here:
<https://aka.ms/AIFutureOfWorkPartner>

Table of Contents

Overview & Positioning	1
What Is Copilot Cowork?	1
Availability & Timeline	2
Scenarios & Use Cases	3
Admin Control Details	4

Overview & Positioning

What Is Copilot Cowork?

1. What is Copilot Cowork?

Copilot Cowork brings long running, multi-step work into M365 Copilot, moving beyond prompts and responses toward execution that unfolds over time. And, with Work IQ, it has the context of your work, not just fragments of data, so it can reason over your relevant materials.

Instead of asking Copilot to generate a single artifact, Cowork allows you to delegate meaningful work and stay in the loop as that work progresses.

With Cowork, Copilot can break down complex requests into steps, reason across tools and files, and carry work forward with visible progress and opportunities to steer. Tasks are no longer confined to a single turn or a single app.

Cowork is built with enterprise needs in mind. Work is observable. Actions are transparent. Documents are immediately enterprise knowledge that's protected and ready to share. Progress can be reviewed, guided, or stopped. And everything operates

within Microsoft's security, identity, and governance framework, so organizations can adopt these capabilities with confidence.

By combining Anthropic's agentic model for multi-step tasks with M365, Copilot Cowork delivers a managed, enterprise grade experience that pairs powerful reasoning with the controls enterprises expect. This is the promise of Copilot: bring the best AI innovation from across the industry and build it for work with the intelligence of Work IQ and trust of Microsoft's Enterprise Data Protection.

2. Is Copilot Cowork safe to use?

Copilot Cowork runs within Microsoft 365's security and governance boundaries with enterprise data protection and DPA. Identity, permissions, and compliance policies apply by default, and actions and outputs are auditable. Cowork runs in a protected, sandboxed cloud environment, so tasks can keep progressing safely as you move across devices. This is what makes execution durable at enterprise scale.

Availability & Timeline

3. When is Copilot Cowork available?

Copilot Cowork is in Frontier Public worldwide (exceptions noted below) and in English only. It will be generally available (GA) in Q3 CY2026. Below is a list of restricted countries that will not have access due to Anthropic due to terms & considerations.

Restricted Countries and Regions

- **China (Including Hong Kong):** Anthropic prohibits access to its services for entities based in China, as well as companies worldwide that are more than 50% owned (directly or indirectly) by Chinese firms. [Updating restrictions of sales to unsupported regions \ Anthropic](#)
- **Other Restricted Jurisdictions:** Services are generally unavailable in embargoed destinations, including **Cuba, North Korea, Iran, Syria,** and the **Crimea, Donetsk, and Luhansk regions of Ukraine.**

4. How users find and install Copilot Cowork?

Users can discover Copilot Cowork through the **Agent Store**, the built-in marketplace within Microsoft 365 Copilot.

In Microsoft 365 Copilot (web or desktop):

1. Open Microsoft 365 Copilot.

2. In the left navigation pane, select **Agents**, then **All agents**.
3. Search for **Copilot Cowork** and select **Add**.

In Microsoft Teams or Outlook:

1. In the right navigation pane, select **Get agents**.
2. Search for **Copilot Cowork** and select **Add**.

Once added, Copilot Cowork appears in the user's agent list in the Copilot rail.

Note: Users can only install Copilot Cowork if your organization has made it available to them. If you've restricted access to specific groups, only those users will see it in the Agent Store.

For more information about how users interact with agents, see [Use agents in Microsoft 365 Copilot](#).

5. How does this impact EU customers? Will they have access?

We plan to make Copilot Cowork, based on Anthropic models, available to EU customers off by default but admins can choose to turn it on for their tenant. Anthropic models deployed in Microsoft offerings (including Microsoft 365 Copilot, Researcher, Copilot Studio, Power Platform, Copilot in Excel, Copilot Cowork and Word, Excel, and PowerPoint agents) are currently excluded from the EU Data Boundary, and when applicable, in-country processing commitments. Customers within the EU Data Boundary and customers in the UK will have Anthropic models disabled by default. Anthropic models aren't currently available for use in government clouds (GCC, GCC High, DoD) or sovereign clouds.

Scenarios & Use Cases

6. What are the main scenarios for Copilot Cowork?

Cowork can accomplish many different long-running, coordination-heavy tasks that require orchestration across multiple apps and systems. Some hero examples include:

- **Clean up your calendar:** Most weeks start with a packed calendar and not enough focus time. Now you can hand that triage over to Cowork. It reviews your Outlook schedule, asks what you are trying to prioritize, and flags conflicts and low-value meetings. Then it proposes changes. Once you approve, it applies the changes by accepting, declining, or rescheduling meetings and adding focus blocks. It can even send you a prep document to the meeting.

- **Prepare for a meeting:** Preparing for a customer meeting can consume your afternoon. With Cowork, you can hand off the effort from start to finish. Cowork pulls relevant inputs from email, meetings, and files, schedules prep time on the calendar, then produces a connected set of deliverables: a client-ready deck, a briefing document to prep for, customer usage data, scheduled prep time already on the calendar, and a draft customer status email update that captures key decisions and attaches the latest files.
- **Research a company fast:** Deep research takes time and rigor. With Cowork, you can offload company research across web and work sources. For example, Cowork gathers earnings reports, Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) filings, analyst commentary, and relevant news, with an emphasis on primary financial data. It then organizes findings with citations. You get an executive summary formatted for email, a structured research memo with clear assumptions and supporting analysis, and an Excel workbook with labeled tabs.
- **Create a product launch plan:** New product launches move fast, especially when the competitive landscape shifts midstream. With Cowork, you can delegate a launch workflow and move quickly from intent to a full-fledged approach. Cowork builds a competitive comparison in Excel, distills differentiation into a value proposition document, and generates a launch customer pitch deck. It can also outline milestones, owners, and next steps.

Admin Control Details

7. How can admins control access to Cowork?

Note, if Cowork is not visible in Microsoft Admin Center Agent management, ensure that the admin account is also enrolled in Frontier (Copilot -> Settings -> Frontier).

You manage Copilot Cowork the same way you manage other Copilot agents—through the **Microsoft 365 admin center**.

Navigation: admin.microsoft.com → **Copilot** → **Agents** → **All agents**

From there, find **Copilot Cowork** and select it to manage its settings.

The key availability controls are:

Setting	Effect
Available to all users	All licensed Copilot users in your tenant can find and install Cowork (default).

Setting	Effect
Available to specific users or groups	Only the users or security groups you specify can find and install Cowork.
Blocked	No users in your tenant can access Cowork.

To restrict access to specific security groups or user segments, select **Available to specific users or groups** and add the relevant groups. This is the recommended approach for phased rollouts or departmental pilots.

Note: Country or region-based scoping is not a supported option for agent availability. Use security groups to represent geographic or organizational segments.

For a full walkthrough of these controls, see [Manage agents in the Microsoft 365 admin center](#).

8. How do admins pre-install Copilot Cowork for their users?

Instead of waiting for users to install Copilot Cowork themselves, admins can **deploy** it on behalf of all users or a specific group. Deploying an agent automatically installs it—users do not need to take any action.

To deploy Copilot Cowork:

1. In the admin center, go to **Copilot → Agents → All agents**.
2. Select **Copilot Cowork**.
3. Under **Deploy to**, choose **Entire organization** or **Specific users/groups**.
4. Select **Deploy**.

When deployed, Copilot Cowork is installed for the target users and appears in their agent list. Users' permissions are accepted on their behalf as part of the deployment.

For details, see [Deploy agents in Microsoft 365 Copilot](#).

9. How do admins pre-pin Copilot Cowork in the Copilot rail?

Pinning makes Copilot Cowork persistently visible in the Copilot rail (the right-side agent panel) without the user needing to open the Agent Store. Pinning is a separate step from deployment—an agent must be deployed before it can be pinned.

To pin Copilot Cowork for your users:

1. In the admin center, go to **Copilot → Agents → Manage pinned agents**.

2. Select **Add a pinned agent** and choose **Copilot Cowork**.
3. Choose whether to pin it for the entire organization or specific groups.
4. Save your changes.

Users will see Copilot Cowork in their Copilot rail the next time they open Copilot. Users can unpin admin-pinned agents from their own view if they prefer.

For more information, see [Manage pinned agents for Microsoft 365 Copilot](#).

10. What is Cowork's security and compliance controls?

Copilot Cowork is subject to the same security and compliance controls that apply to the agents in Microsoft 365 Copilot.

Cowork's design mirrors M365 Copilot: output files inherit the highest label from any files you uploaded in the conversation (the "high watermark" pattern). If no labeled files were uploaded, the tenant's default label applies. Cowork does not currently have its own default-label override control — that's governed at the tenant admin level in Microsoft Purview. The intended future state is that admins can control default labels via Microsoft Purview policy, and Cowork will respect and propagate those labels on output files.

11. What is Cowork's Data Loss Prevention (DLP)?

Microsoft Purview DLP policies apply to Copilot agent interactions. Sensitive information—such as content matching DLP rules or documents with sensitivity labels—can be blocked from being processed by Copilot agents, including Copilot Cowork.

See [Learn about the Microsoft 365 Copilot location for DLP](#).

12. What is Cowork's audit logs?

All interactions with Copilot Cowork are captured in the Microsoft Purview audit log under **Copilot activities**. Log entries include the agent name, agent ID, and version. These logs are available at no additional cost under Audit Standard.

See [Audit log activities for Microsoft 365 Copilot](#).

13. What is Cowork's data residency?

Conversation content processed by Copilot Cowork is stored in your tenant's local region geography by default. Advanced Data Residency (ADR) and Multi-Geo configurations are also honored. See [Data residency for Microsoft 365 Copilot](#).

14. Is there an option to enable Anthropic by groups?

Currently there are no granular controls available that allow customers to limit Anthropic model usage by group/user. They are on the public [roadmap](#) for customer tracking.

15. What are admin links I should share to my customers to better understand all their management and compliance capabilities?

- [Manage agents in the Microsoft 365 admin center](#)
- [Agent availability settings](#)
- [Deploy agents in Microsoft 365 Copilot](#)
- [Microsoft 365 Copilot agent installation overview](#)
- [Agents admin guide for Microsoft 365 Copilot](#)
- [Data residency for Microsoft 365 Copilot.](#)
- [Audit log activities for Microsoft 365 Copilot](#)
- [Learn about the Microsoft 365 Copilot location for DLP](#)